YOUR BRAIN

8 neuroscience facts about the organ reading this page

1. ## 86 billion neurons

Your brain has about 86 billion nerve cells, each linked to thousands of others by synapses.

2. ## Small but hungry

The brain is about 2% of body weight but uses roughly 20% of your body's energy at rest.

3. ## Fast signals

Some nerve signals travel at over 100 metres per second along insulated (myelinated) fibres.

4. ## No pain inside

Brain tissue has no pain receptors, which is why some brain surgery can be done while the patient is awake.

5. ## Sleep cleans up

During deep sleep, fluid flows through the brain and helps wash away waste made during the day.

6. ## Neuroplasticity

Learning physically changes the brain. Practice strengthens connections between neurons that fire together.

7. ## Two halves talk

The left and right halves are linked by the corpus callosum, a bridge of roughly 140 to 200 million nerve fibres.

8. ## The memory seahorse

The hippocampus, named after the Greek word for seahorse, helps turn experiences into long-term memories.

WOW NUMBER

Your brain has roughly 100 trillion synapses - hundreds of times more than the 100 to 400 billion stars in the Milky Way.